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GRANTS

How to write a grant budget assessors believe

6 steps to a budget that holds up

Swipe →

01

Tie every cost to an activity

Each budget line should link to something in your project plan. Costs with no activity behind them look like padding.

02

Back major items with quotes

Use written quotes or documented pricing for the larger items instead of rough estimates. Evidence makes a number credible.

03

Check what is eligible

Read the guidelines for eligible and ineligible expenditure before you build the budget. Ineligible items can raise questions about the rest.

04

Show your own contribution

Many programs expect applicants to put in their own funds. Show where yours comes from and when it will be available.

05

Keep the figures consistent

Totals, GST treatment and timing should agree across the budget, the project plan and the cash flow. Mismatches cost credibility.

06

Explain your assumptions

Add a short note on how you calculated each major line. Assessors read faster when they do not have to guess.

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Pass it on

Share it with a founder preparing a grant application.